

Max I. Kagan

Columbia Business School
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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Columbia Business School

Postdoctoral Research Scholar, Management Division 2024–present

University of Chicago Booth School of Business

Stigler Center, Affiliate Fellow 2026–2029

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Ph.D., Political Science 2024

M.A., Political Science 2021

Middlebury College

B.A., Political Science 2014

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- [3] Frake, Justin*, Reuben Hurst*, and Max Kagan*. **“Political Segregation in the U.S. Workplace.”** Forthcoming at *Nature Human Behavior*.
- American Political Science Association Dorothy Day Award for Outstanding Labor Research (2025)
 - Media coverage: [Niskanen Center](#)
- [2] Kagan, Max*, Justin Frake*, and Reuben Hurst*, 2026. **“VRscores: A Voter Registration-Based Approach for Measuring Workforce Politics.”** *Organization Science*, 37(2):444–465.
- Politics at Work website
- [1] Brutger, Ryan*, Stephen Chaudoin*, and Max Kagan*, 2023. **“Trade Wars and Election Interference.”** *Review of International Organizations*, 18:1–25.

* denotes equal authorship

WORKING PAPERS

- [5] Hurst, Reuben*, Max Kagan*, Matthew Lee*, and Justin Frake*. **“Workplaces as Engines of Democratic Participation.”** Revise and resubmit at *Administrative Science Quarterly*.
- Strategic Management Society Annual Conference Research Methods Paper Prize (*nominated*) (2026)
 - Media coverage: [Harvard BiGS](#)
- [4] White, James*, Reuben Hurst*, and Max Kagan*. **“Corporate Political Stances and Employee Turnover.”** Revise and resubmit at *Management Science*.

- Strategic Management Society Strategic Human Capital Interest Group Best Paper Prize (2025)
 - Strategic Management Annual Conference Best Paper Prize (*nominated*) (2025)
- [3] Kagan, Max. **“Business on the Ballot: Employee Voting as Nonmarket Strategy.”**
- [2] Kagan, Max, and Vanessa Burbano. **“Beyond Left and Right: New Evidence on Consumer Reactions to Corporate Sociopolitical Stance-Taking.”**
- AOM Annual Meeting Best Paper Designation (2025)
- [1] **“Where Americans Work Shapes Whether They Vote: Evidence From 30 Million U.S. Workers”** (with Justin Frake, Matthew Lee, and Reuben Hurst)

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EARLIER-STAGE PROJECTS

- [2] “Organizational Political Stratification: Extent, Causes, Effects” (with JT Gartner, Justin Frake, and Reuben Hurst)
- [1] “Partisan Firm Positioning”

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Fellowships

- National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Program (NSF GRFP) #2146752, 2021–2024 \$141,000
- Law, Economics, and Policy (LEAP) Center, Berkeley Law, 2022–2023 \$9,000

Grants

- University of Michigan “U.S. at 250” Grant, 2026 (with Justin Frake) \$5,000
- National Science Foundation Advanced Cyberinfrastructure Coordination Ecosystem: Services & Support (ACCESS), “SOC260009: Using Big Data to Measure Stakeholder Ideology,” 2026 400,000 credits
- University of Michigan “Year of Democracy” Grant, 2025 (with Justin Frake) \$5,000
- Faculty Research Grant, Bernstein Center for Leadership and Ethics Columbia Business School, 2024–2025 (with Vanessa Burbano) \$10,000
- Berkeley Economy and Society Initiative (Hewlett Foundation), 2024 \$2,500
- Berkeley Graduate Division Travel Grant, 2024 \$1,500
- Berkeley Graduate Division Travel Grant, 2024 \$900
- Berkeley Economy and Society Initiative (Hewlett Foundation), 2023 \$4,600
- Berkeley Center for the Study of American Democracy (CSAD), 2023 \$2,500
- Berkeley Network for a New Political Economy (N2PE), 2022 \$2,000
- American Political Science Association (APSA) Travel Grant, 2021 \$300
- Berkeley Political Science Departmental Award, 2021 \$2,600

INVITED TALKS

2026

- Civic Summit (*featured research presentation at Civic Alliance summit*)
- IE University (Strategy)

2025

- Michigan Ross (Strategy)
- Rice (Organizational Behavior)
- University of Texas at Austin (Business, Government, and Society)

† *denotes scheduled*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026

- Academy of Management (Philadelphia)†
- Berkeley Culture Connect Conference
- Oxford University Saïd Business School Centre for Corporate Reputation Symposium†
- Strategy Science (*declined due to schedule conflict*)
- Sumantra Ghoshal Strategy Conference (London Business School)

† *denotes scheduled*

2025

- Academy of Management (Copenhagen)
- Alliance for Research on Corporate Sustainability (HEC Paris)
- Columbia–Cornell Political Economy of Work Junior Scholars Workshop (Columbia)
- Non-Market Strategy Research Consortium Doctoral Conference (virtual)
- People & Organizations Conference (Wharton)
- Strategic Management Society (San Francisco)
- Strategy and the Business Environment (Wharton)

2024

- Academy of Management (Chicago)
- Bay Area Affective Polarization Workshop (Stanford)
- Consortium on the American Political Economy (virtual)
- Copenhagen Business School–Princeton Money in Politics Conference (Copenhagen)
- Midwest Political Science Association (Chicago)
- Non-Market Strategy Research Consortium Doctoral Conference (virtual)
- Polarization Research Lab Annual Meeting (New Orleans, LA)
- Stanford-Berkeley American Politics Conference (Stanford GSB)
- Strategic Management Society Special Conference (Washington, D.C.)

2023

- American Political Science Association (Los Angeles)
- Conference on Field Experiments in Strategy (CFXS) (Harvard Business School)
- Junior Americanist Workshop Series (JAWS) MPSA Pre-Conference (Chicago)
- Midwest Political Science Association (Chicago)

2021

- American Political Science Association (Seattle)

- Graduate Student International Political Economy (GSIFE) (virtual)

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **Strategic Management Society:** Research Methods Paper Prize (*nominated*) 2026
- **Strategic Management Society:** Strategic Human Capital Interest Group Best Paper Prize 2025
- **Strategic Management Society:** Best Paper Prize (*nominated*) 2025
- **Academy of Management:** Best Paper Designation 2025
- **American Political Science Assoc.:** Dorothy Day Award for Outstanding Labor Research 2025
- **University of California, Berkeley:** Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award 2022
- **Phi Beta Kappa** 2014

SERVICE TO THE DISCIPLINE

Journal Reviewer

- Management: *Management Science*, *Organization Science* (×7), *Strategic Management Journal* (×4)
- Political Science: *Business and Politics* (×2), *Journal of Politics* (×2), *Review of International Organizations* (×2)

Organizer

- “Workplace Sorting by Political Partisanship” Symposium, AOM 2024, 2025

Invited Participation

- “Cross-Pollinating Corporate Political Activity (CPA): The Future of the Field” Academy of Management (*panelist*) 2026
- “New Theoretical and Empirical Research Opportunities from Examining Career Histories (Revelio PDW),” Academy of Management (*invited discussant*) 2026
- Consortium on the American Political Economy–Junior Working Group (*invited discussant*) 2025
- “Macro and Micro Perspectives on Political Ideology and Partisanship in Organizations,” Academy of Management (*panelist*) 2025
- “Research Frontiers in Nonmarket Strategy,” Academy of Management (*invited discussant*) 2025

Committee Service

- Dorothy Day Award Committee, American Political Science Assoc. Labor Politics Group 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California, Berkeley

- The Politics of Public Policy (undergraduate; TA for David Broockman)
- International Political Economy (undergraduate; TA for Ryan Brutger)
- War in the Middle East (undergraduate; TA for Ron Hassner)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Good Jobs Institute, Cambridge, MA

Associate

2018–19

Non-profit consultancy that helps companies thrive by creating good jobs.

Long Ridge Equity Partners, New York City

Associate

2017–18

Growth equity firm investing in financial and business technology companies.

McKinsey & Company

Senior Business Analyst

2016–17

Private Equity & Principal Investors Practice, New York City

Business Analyst

2014–16

Middle East Office, Dubai

Served clients in banking, telecommunications, and the public sector across Saudi Arabia, Qatar, and the United States; conducted market due diligence for private equity firms.

REFERENCES

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